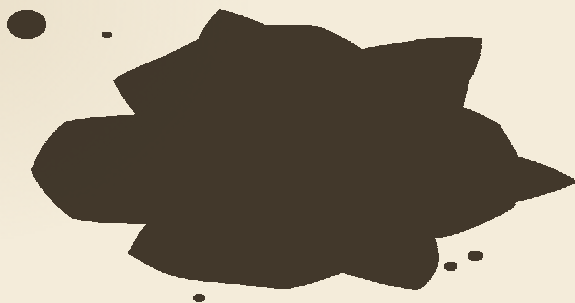




INTERVAL

A HANDBOOK



world fd0e9bcc508

One interval a second since the founding

THIS COPY BELONGS TO

CITIZEN

PRINTED AT INTERVAL

SWORN TO

◆

This book describes world **fd0e9bccc508**. That is not a version number: it is a checksum of the rules. Change one character of them and you get a different world with a different name. Nothing in this book can go out of date, because nothing in the rules can change.

ABOUT INTERVAL

Interval is an online world run by the computers of the people playing it. There is no company behind it and no server that owns it. There is no account either. You have a key, and the key is your citizen.

The rules were set when the world was founded and cannot be changed by anyone, including the people who wrote them. That is why nobody can ban you, patch you or shut it down, and why this book can be printed at all.

This book lists the rules: the crafts, the items, the recipes, the spells and the levels. It does not tell you what to do, where anything is, or how to make money. Those are not rules, and you work them out by playing.

How the world is drawn is not part of the rules. The window you are using is one way of showing it and there is no official one. You can write your own and it counts the same.

THE INTERVAL

The world advances one interval every second, whether or not anyone is playing. Everything happens on an interval: a step, an attack, a log cut, a line of chat.

Nothing speeds this up. There is nothing to buy, and the world does not pause when you log off.



NINETY MINUTES

You can play one citizen for ninety minutes a day. This is in the rules, so every window enforces it.

When the ninety minutes are used up, you are done for the day.

THE NINE CRAFTS

Every citizen has the same nine and can train all of them. The right column lists the trades you can swear to in that craft.



Woodcraft

forester, firekeeper, fletcher



Earthcraft

miner, smith



Shorecraft

fisher, cook



Mourning

mourner



Marksmanship

archer



Sorcery

alchemist



Hearthcraft

farmer, brewer



Prowess

berserker, warden, fighter



Wayfaring

cartographer, runner

SWEARING TO A TRADE

You can swear to one trade once you reach **50** in its craft. It is the only craft you can master.

Unsworn	nothing passes 50
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Outside your trade	nothing passes 70
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Your own craft	mastery at 100
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Nothing stacks up across crafts. Each citizen masters one craft and stays middling at the other eight, so most of what you need you will get from other players.

THE TITLES

What a master of each craft is called.

Woodcraft	woodwright
Earthcraft	smith
Shorecraft	shorekeeper
Mourning	mourner
Marksmanship	archer
Sorcery	alchemist
Wayfaring	wayfarer
Hearthcraft	hearthkeeper
Prowess	fighter

PAST MASTERY

Mastery is a power cap, not a level cap. Everything in the world uses your level or 100, whichever is lower, so nothing you do gets stronger past it. Levels carry on to **210** and count for nothing but showing how long you have played.

They do give you apprentice slots, one at each of 100, 105, 110, so a high-level master can teach more people.

CARRYING

Your pack holds **12** items. Crafting only uses what is in your pack, never what is in the bank, so you have to decide what to take before you leave town.

WORN

Weapon

Head

Body

Offhand

Legs

ARMS

BOW

marksmanship



horn bow +

20



hollow bow

1



sigil bow +

30



heartwood bow +

40

CROSSBOW

marksmanship



great crossbow +

70



crossbow +

25

DAGGER

prowess



iron dagger

8



steel dagger

35



quick dagger

50

JAVELIN

marksmanship



iron javelin

1



steel javelin

15



quick javelin

50

MELL

prowess



iron mell +

22



steel mell +

38



quick mell +

55



great mell

70

SPEAR

prowess



iron spear +

14



steel spear +

35

ARMS (CONTINUED)

 quick spear +	50	 bone spear +	50
---	----	--	----

SWORD

prowess

 iron sword	15	 steel sword	35
 quick sword	50	 great sword +	70

OTHER

 barb	45	 bare blade	30
 bone staff	40	 fire siphon	60
 gold chain	30	 handgonne +	90
 quick flail +	55	 spade	260
 wand	6	 wooden bow +	8

Where a craft is named beside the family, the number is the level you need to hold the thing. Everywhere else it is what a stall pays for one, and blank means stalls do not buy it. A + means it takes both hands, so no shield.

ARMOUR

HELM

prowess

 iron helm	12	 steel helm	32
 quick helm	45	 great helm	70
 gold helm	45	 shell helm	15

PLATE

prowess

 iron plate	30	 steel plate	38
 quick plate	50	 great plate	70
 gold plate	50	 shell plate	15

OTHER

 king shroud	40
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Where a craft is named beside the family, the number is the level you need to hold the thing. Everywhere else it is what a stall pays for one, and blank means stalls do not buy it. A + means it takes both hands, so no shield.

MADE THINGS

HATCHET

woodcraft

 iron hatchet	10	 steel hatchet	10
 quick hatchet	30	 great hatchet	70

PICKAXE

earthcraft

 iron pickaxe	10	 steel pickaxe	10
 quick pickaxe	30	 great pickaxe	70

SHIELD

prowess

 iron shield	1	 steel shield	30
 quick shield	48		

OTHER

 gold bar	320	 gold legs	45
 iron	5	 quick alloy	
 quick grit		 quick ingot	420
 shot	2		

MADE THINGS (CONTINUED)



steel

Where a craft is named beside the family, the number is the level you need to hold the thing. Everywhere else it is what a stall pays for one, and blank means stalls do not buy it. A + means it takes both hands, so no shield.

GOODS

ARROWS

 fire arrows	12	 arrows	1
---	----	--	---

BONES

 dragon bones	500	 bones	2
--	-----	---	---

BREAD

 burnt bread	1	 bread	9
---	---	---	---

BROTH

 deep broth	24	 broth	10
--	----	---	----

DEEP FISH

 cooked deep fish	22	 salt deep fish	30
--	----	--	----

 burnt deep fish	1
---	---

EEL

 cooked eel	13	 smoked eel	30
--	----	--	----

 burnt eel	1	 eel	7
---	---	---	---

FISH

 raw fish	3	 cooked fish	6
--	---	---	---

GOODS (CONTINUED)

 salt fish	11	 deep fish	11
---	----	---	----

LOGS

 oak logs	6	 logs	2
--	---	--	---

ORE

 iron ore	4	 gold ore	60
 ore	5		

ROD

shorecraft

 heartwood rod	70	 ironbark rod	30
 oak rod	10	 rod	10

STAFF

sorcery

 heartwood staff +	70	 staff +	6
--	----	--	---

OTHER

 ale	8	 brimstone	46
 charcoal	12	 chart	180
 charter	240	 coal	12

GOODS (CONTINUED)

 crab shell	12	 flour	6
 grain	4	 grave silver	700
 gunpowder	60	 heartwood	15
 holy water	90	 ironbark	9
 lamprey spit	90	 planks	5
 quick stone	20	 saltpetre	14
sapling	40	 seeds	10
 wool	9		

Where a craft is named beside the family, the number is the level you need to hold the thing. Everywhere else it is what a stall pays for one, and blank means stalls do not buy it. A + means it takes both hands, so no shield.

THE SPELLS

There are 11 spells, split between two spellbooks. A citizen has one book or the other, never both. Casting a spell uses up a sigil.

THE COMMON BOOK

85	still	hold a fight still
	seal	hold a dropped pack for whoever lost it
1	transmute	
50	mend	close your own wounds
50	mendp	close somebody else's, with a wand
	unmake	take a thing apart
	anchor	the recall to Anchor

None of these damage anyone. They block, heal or break things down.

THE BARROW BOOK

The other spellbook. These are the ones that harm.

75 **waking**

40 **rot**

60 **taking**

88 **withering**

What each spell does, and what it costs, is not listed here.

No spell from either book works on the Lists.

DYING

When you are killed you drop everything you were carrying. It lies on the ground where you fell, for anyone to pick up, and it rots after a while like anything else left out.

The world pauses over you for 5 intervals and then you are up again. Nothing is taken from your crafts: levels do not fall here, and there is no penalty beyond the loss of what you had on you.

WHAT IS COUNTED

Your deaths are counted, forever, and the number never falls. It is not a punishment and nothing in the world reads it except the boards. You are free to farm it if you want to, at the price of everything you are carrying each time.

Kills are **not** counted, and that is deliberate. A kill count would be worth something, and the cheapest way to earn it would be to make new citizens and cut them down. A death count is a joke you paid for.

WHAT CAN BE SAVED

At mourning 70 the most valuable priced thing you are carrying survives your death. Only priced things: the ore, the blades, the plate. What this world is really worth keeping is not on any price list, and a sigil, a chart or an old chain is exactly as losable as it always was.

Somebody with a goo-staff can also seal your dropped pack where it lies, which holds it for you and stops it rotting. See the spells.

THE WILDS

Most of the island is ordinary ground, where nobody may strike you without answering for it. The Wilds are not. Anybody may hunt anybody there, and nobody is coming.

Everything worth the most is there, which is the trade: the quick rock, the mother lode, the deep water, the gallows-oaks. You cannot reach the end of any craft without going, and every trip back is carrying something worth taking.

Magic will not carry you out of it either. The recall is the one spell that works there and it goes to Anchor, and you may be cut down in the middle of casting it.

THE LISTS

An isle off Fenmarch, reached by boat. Anybody may strike anybody, and no spell from either book works at all.

It is for a fight that is only about the fight. With the magic gone and nothing else in the way, a mell and a bare blade can be compared honestly.

GAMBITS

Seven weapons have a move of their own. Blows is how many it lands. Recovery is how many intervals your arm is spent for afterwards. Costs is that recovery measured against the weapon's ordinary swing: how many normal blows you gave up to make this one.

			BLOWS	RECOVERY	COSTS
	dragonbow	far	1	4	2
	horn bow	flurry	3	6	3
	quick dagger	flurry	4	8	4
	fire siphon	now	1	4	2
	handgonne	report	1	3	0.75
	great mell	whole	2	3	1.5
	quick mell	whole	2	4	2

THE FOUR KINDS

flurry	several blows in one go, each rolled to hit as usual
whole	one blow at the weapon's hardest, and harder to land
now	does not wait for your arm after an ordinary swing
far	the damage comes from the range, not the weapon

A far shot is weaker than a dagger at touching range and the hardest blow in the world at the end of its nine tiles. The range is the whole of its damage, not an addition to it.

A report is the handgonne alone. Its burst was scaled down when a citizen's flesh became a flat sixty-four, and all of the damage went into the single shot: the hardest blow in the world, and the least accurate. It is the only gambit more likely to miss than to land.

What a gambit costs is not the same for every weapon. The recovery is measured against that weapon's own swing, so the cost column on the previous page is how many ordinary blows you gave up for it: four for a quick dagger, two for a mell, less than one for a handgonne.

Each kind is meant to pay that cost back in its own coin. A flurry pays in blows, a whole in size, a now in timing, a far in distance.

Master your own craft and the arm comes back a quarter sooner, which is what prowess gives instead of hitting harder.

GATHERING

Everything you can gather from, what it gives, and the level you need to use it.

 rock	ore	1
 rockfall	rubble	1
 iron rock	iron ore	1
 coal rock	coal	20
 brimstone vent	brimstone	70
 quick rock	quick stone	78
 gold rock	gold ore	85
 mother lode	quick stone ×2	92
 muck heap	saltpetre	25
 fishing spot	raw fish	1
 eel spot	eel	20

GATHERING (CONTINUED)

	deep fish spot	deep fish	78
	gibbet shoal	deep fish ×2	92
	tree	logs	1
	oak tree	oak logs	20
	ironbark tree	ironbark	45
	heartwood tree	heartwood	78
	gallows oak	heartwood ×2	92

This book does not say where any of it is on the island.

THE KEEPERS

Every town has some. They buy and sell, and each one deals in one thing only.

the axe man	lumber
the delver	delve
the arms master	arms
the armourer	armour
the fletcher	bows
the seedsman	seed
the banker	banker
the merchant	merchant
the sawyer	sawyer
the shepherd	shepherd
the delver	delver
the miller	miller
the quarrier	quarrier
the watchman	watchman
the wizard	wizard
the fisher	fisher

THE KEEPERS (CONTINUED)

the brewer	brewer
the mourner	mourner
the innkeeper	innkeeper
the collier	collier
the drover	drover
the bridge keeper	toll
the beekeeper	beekeeper

Which town has which, and where they stand in it, this book does not say.

RECIPES



iron dagger

1 iron



iron spear

1 iron, 1 logs



iron javelin

1 iron, 1 logs



steel javelin

1 steel, 1 logs



quick javelin

1 quick ingot, 1 ironbark



iron mell

2 iron, 1 logs



sigil bow

1 horn bow, 3 sigil



crossbow

2 iron, 2 logs



quick flail

8 quick ingot, 1 ironbark



fire siphon

4 steel, 6 brimstone, 1 ironbark



bare blade

4 steel, 1 ironbark



bone spear

2 dragon bones, 1 ironbark



barb

2 lamprey spit, 1 steel



handgonne

8 iron, 1 ironbark, 2 brimstone

RECIPES (CONTINUED)

	shot	1 iron, 1 gunpowder
	quick spear	6 quick ingot, 1 ironbark
	quick mell	9 quick ingot, 1 ironbark
	great helm	2 quick alloy
	great plate	5 quick alloy
	shell helm	2 crab shell, 1 iron
	shell plate	4 crab shell, 2 iron
	great sword	5 quick alloy, 1 ironbark
	great crossbow	4 quick alloy, 1 ironbark
	great mell	6 quick alloy, 1 ironbark
	iron sword	2 iron
	iron hatchet	1 iron, 1 logs
	iron pickaxe	1 iron, 1 logs
	iron helm	1 iron

RECIPES (CONTINUED)



iron plate

3 iron



iron shield

4 iron, 1 oak logs



steel shield

3 steel, 1 ironbark



quick shield

7 quick ingot, 1 ironbark



gold legs

8 gold bar



quick grit

5 quick stone



quick ingot

8 quick grit



quick alloy

1 quick ingot, 5 brimstone



quick sword

6 quick ingot



quick helm

5 quick ingot



quick plate

10 quick ingot



quick dagger

4 quick ingot



quick hatchet

2 quick stone, 1 iron, 1 logs



quick pickaxe

2 quick stone, 1 iron, 1 logs

RECIPES (CONTINUED)



steel hatchet 1 steel, 1 oak logs



steel pickaxe 1 steel, 1 oak logs



steel sword 1 steel



steel mell 2 steel, 1 oak logs



steel helm 1 steel



steel plate 2 steel



steel dagger 1 steel



steel spear 1 steel, 1 oak logs



great hatchet 2 quick stone, 2 ironbark, 1 brimstone



great pickaxe 2 quick stone, 1 ironbark, 1 brimstone



gold bar 5 gold ore



iron 2 iron ore



steel 1 iron



gold helm 6 gold bar

RECIPES (CONTINUED)



gold plate

11 gold bar



gold chain

10 gold bar, 1 old chain



bone staff

2 logs, 8 bones, 1 grave silver

CREATURES

goblin

scree imp

wolf

troll

bear

shore crab

dummy

butt

boar

mountain goat

carrion crow

fen adder

gibbet dead

quencher

barrow wight

sheep

siren

great spider

dragon

mere lamprey

skeleton knight

incursion

risen

gibbet king

This book does not say where they live.

THE FOUNDING

This book describes the world with the following id, and no other.

fd0e9bccc5085de663abb0863d3a7dcf
ff4879883c0a97899c62463a7cfc205b

Take a SHA-256 checksum of the rules yourself and you should get this.
If you get something else, you are playing a different world.

